

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Operations Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Detection Engineering | SOC | Remote UK

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certified Senior Security Operations Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience building, operating, and continuously improving enterprise Security Operations Centre (SOC) capabilities using Microsoft security technologies. I have deep expertise in administering Microsoft Sentinel as a Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, writing Kusto Query Language (KQL) queries to engineer advanced detection rules, build analytic workbooks, and drive threat hunting programmes. I have deployed and managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender (M365 Defender) across an estate of over 8,000 users, and I am highly experienced in alert triage, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development, and incident response aligned to NIST 800-61 and the MITRE Adversarial Tactics, Techniques, and Common Knowledge (ATT&CK) framework. I am passionate about challenging the status quo by improving detection capabilities, reducing false positive rates, and driving automation across security operations workflows. I am also expert-level in CrowdStrike Falcon endpoint detection and response (EDR) and Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), and I bring strong experience in vulnerability management, identity and access management (IAM), and Privileged Access Management (PAM). I am looking for a fully remote Senior Security Operations Engineer role where I can make a visible impact by shaping detection strategy, influencing tooling decisions, and helping define the future direction of a growing security operations team.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM / Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytic rules, workbooks, threat hunting), CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, detection-as-practice including rule authoring, tuning, and false-positive reduction
- **Extended Detection and Response (XDR) / EDR:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), M365 Defender, CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover) at expert level across 8,000+ user estate
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, SOAR workflow automation, PowerShell scripting, alert triage automation, incident orchestration
- **Incident Response:** End-to-end incident response lifecycle (NIST 800-61), threat containment, eradication and recovery, post-incident reporting, playbook development
- **Threat Hunting:** KQL-based proactive threat hunting, IOC/IOA hunting, hypothesis-driven investigations using MITRE ATT&CK mapping
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentra BAS, Nessus, scan scheduling, risk-prioritised remediation tracking
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM) / PAM:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure security posture, log ingestion into Sentinel, cloud workload monitoring, Entra ID governance
- **Email Security:** Mimecast (email gateway, anti-phishing, sandboxing, DKIM/DMARC)
- **Additional Tools:** Microsoft Intune (MDM/MAM), Check Point Harmony Endpoint, Tanium, Splunk/SPL
- **Frameworks:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), Cyber Essentials Plus, ISO 27001, CIS Controls

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Lead security operations across a highly customised Microsoft security environment serving over 8,000 users, including Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, MDE, MDI, and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/NG-SIEM.
- Engineer and maintain detection capabilities in Microsoft Sentinel, authoring and tuning KQL-based analytic rules aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, reducing false positive alert volume and improving signal-to-noise ratio.
- Drive proactive threat hunting campaigns using KQL across Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, identifying emerging threats and adversarial behaviour patterns before they generate automated alerts.
- Develop and improve SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel and PowerShell automation scripts, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and eliminating repetitive manual triage tasks across the SOC.
- Challenge the status quo in security tooling by identifying opportunities to improve detection logic, onboard new data sources, and optimise the Microsoft security environment for comprehensive coverage.
- Lead incident response activities end-to-end using the NIST 800-61 lifecycle, from detection and containment through eradication, recovery, and post-incident review.
- Manage BeyondTrust PAM to enforce least-privilege access and audit all privileged account activity, and administer Microsoft Entra ID including Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO at scale.
- Operate vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentra BAS, coordinating risk-prioritised remediation with infrastructure and application teams.
- Manage Mimecast email security gateway, tuning anti-phishing policies, DKIM/DMARC alignment, and sandboxing to protect the organisation against email-borne threats.
- Mentor junior analysts on detection engineering techniques, KQL query construction, and threat hunting methodologies, helping to raise the overall technical capability of the security team.
- Contribute to ISO 27001 compliance and Cyber Essentials Plus recertification, delivering evidence collation and stakeholder reporting.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Operated Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform, writing KQL detection rules, performing threat hunting, and building custom workbooks and dashboards to track security metrics for senior stakeholders.
- Deployed and managed MDE, MDI, and M365 Defender across 8,000 endpoints and user identities, configuring detection policies, custom indicators of compromise (IOCs), and response actions to improve SOC detection fidelity.
- Administered CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover) across the full university estate, managing sensor deployment, group policies, alert triage, and containment actions.
- Built and improved SOAR automation in Microsoft Sentinel and via PowerShell, automating alert enrichment, IOC lookups, and common response tasks to reduce analyst workload.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including user lifecycle, Conditional Access, MFA deployment, and SSO configuration across staff and student populations.
- Maintained BeyondTrust PAM, including privileged session recording, credential vaulting, and access reviews, ensuring full auditability of privileged activity.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-prioritised reports and tracking remediation through to closure with infrastructure teams.
- Operated Mimecast for email gateway security, managing filtering policies, phishing detection, DKIM/DMARC alignment, and continuity service testing.
- Responded to security incidents using NIST 800-61, producing post-incident reports and contributing to playbook enhancements to improve future response efficiency.
- Contributed new ideas for improving detection capabilities, including onboarding additional data sources into Sentinel and refining detection logic to reduce false positives.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Managed endpoint security controls and Mobile Device Management / Mobile Application Management (MDM/MAM) configuration across a SaaS/FinTech cloud environment, implementing and monitoring security baselines.

- Implemented and administered MFA and IAM controls, managing identity governance processes and access reviews to maintain least-privilege principles across all user accounts.
- Managed cloud security posture in Microsoft Azure, including role-based access control (RBAC), log management, and security monitoring configuration, contributing to early detection of anomalous activity.
- Conducted internal vulnerability assessments and coordinated remediation with development and infrastructure teams, prioritising findings by severity and business risk.
- Supported ISO 27001 and SOC 2 compliance activities, including control mapping, evidence collection, gap analysis, and remediation tracking.
- Administered firewall rules and network security policies, supporting Intrusion Detection and Prevention System (IDS/IPS) log monitoring and incident escalation.
- Delivered security awareness training and contributed to process documentation to embed security best practices across the organisation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Improved detection capabilities in Microsoft Sentinel by engineering and continuously tuning KQL-based analytic rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, significantly reducing false positive alert rates and improving SOC response efficiency.
- Led deployment and management of MDE and M365 Defender across 8,000 endpoints and user identities at UAL, establishing a unified XDR capability with Microsoft Sentinel as the central SIEM for correlated alerting.
- Drove detection and response automation via Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks and PowerShell scripting, reducing manual triage workload and accelerating mean time to respond (MTTR) for common threat scenarios.
- Expert management of CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/NG-SIEM across 8,000+ users, maintaining near-100% sensor coverage and driving proactive threat hunting to surface threats before they escalate.
- Designed and implemented BeyondTrust PAM solution, establishing privileged access management, session recording, and audit trail for all administrative accounts across the university.
- Consistently challenged the status quo by identifying improvements to detection logic, onboarding new data sources into Sentinel, and contributing new ideas to improve the overall security operations posture.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)